Anika Ibnat

Graduate Student & Teaching Assistant
Department of Political Science
University of Houston

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Research Interests

Technology and Governance, Public Policy, and Political Methodology

Education

University of Houston

Ph.D. in Political Science (In Progress) 2025–Present

University of Mississippi

Doctoral Study in Political Science (Non-Degree) 2024–2025

University of Texas at San Antonio

M.A. in Global Affairs 2022–2024

Jahangirnagar University

M.S.S. in International Relations 2020–2021

B.S.S. in International Relations 2015–2019

Positions

Jahangirnagar University

President, International Relations Club 2020–2021

Questions; Counter-Questions; and Perhaps Answers

Founding Member & Executive 2017–2021

Voice of International Affairs

Associate Member 2020–2021

Honors

2026 **Conference Participation Travel Grant** — *Department of Political Science, University of Houston* — Awarded $800 to support travel and registration for presenting co-authored research at the 2026 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

2025 **Presidential Fellowship** — *Graduate School, University of Houston* — Merit-based fellowship awarded for Fall 2025–Spring 2027 in recognition of academic excellence during the first two years of the Ph.D. program.

2024 **Graduate Assistantship with Scholarship** — *University of Mississippi* — Competitive graduate assistantship for Fall 2024–Spring 2025, including scholarship, full tuition waiver, and student health insurance.

2022 **Dean's Merit Scholarship** — *University of Texas at San Antonio* — Awarded by the College of Liberal and Fine Arts in recognition of a strong graduate application.

2022 **Most Diplomatic Delegate Award** — *UTSA Model United Nations Society*

2016 **Merit-Based Stipend** — *Jahangirnagar University* — Awarded annually from 2016 to 2019 based on academic progress and standing.

Publications

Ibnat, Anika. 2024. "TikTok and the National Security Concern: Data Privacy, Geopolitics, and Strategic Framing." *Beyond Boundaries Journal.*

Master's Thesis

Ibnat, Anika. 2024. "Media Narratives of Asian Rising Powers: Democracy Promotion & Strategic Influence." M.A. thesis, University of Texas at San Antonio.

Working Papers

Zhu, Ling, Lydia Tiede, Anika Ibnat, and Bonhoon Koo. 2026. "Algorithm Governance: Political Institutions and AI Policies in Democracies."

Ibnat, Anika. 2026a. "The Diffusion of Policies Addressing Technology-Facilitated Violence Against Women and Girls in Europe, 2015–2024."

Ibnat, Anika. 2026b. "When Democracies Pull the Plug: A Game-Theoretic Model of Internet Shutdowns Under Uncertainty."

Conference Presentations

Zhu, Ling, Lydia Tiede, **Anika Ibnat**, and Bonhoon Koo. 2026. "Algorithm Governance: Political Institutions and AI Policies in Democracies." Paper presented at the American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Boston, MA.

Research and Technical Skills

Research Methods: Quantitative Analysis, Qualitative Interviewing, Mixed-Methods Research, Content Analysis, Mathematical Modeling.

Software and Programming: R, Stata, RStudio, Quarto, Git, GitHub, Microsoft Excel, Microsoft PowerPoint.

Languages

Bengali (Native); Hindi (Native); Urdu (Fluent Speaking and Listening); English (Fluent).